detached from a larger entity and settled in a distant place. ‘Imperium’ is the exercise of command or domination of one people by a stronger people. Therefore, ‘imperialism’ implies pacification and domination.[2]

Palmer and Perkins[3] point out that some scholars like Hobson, in his famous work, *Imperialism: A Study,* gave the essence of colonialism as “a natural overflow of nationality wherein groups of colonists are sent out to a foreign, and ordinarily more backward, land or go of their own volition to settle and take up the land”, followed by the transplantation of their civilization and political institutions and retaining the territory of the home country. Imperialism, on the other hand, is regarded as “something more organized, more military, more self-consciously aggressive”. The distinction can be understood in teleological terms and in terms of purposes and ends sought. When rule over foreign territories is sought primarily for the economic, political or military benefit of the central homeland, the action assumes the characteristics of imperialism, though it may not always be regarded as such. Where rule is undertaken within a colonial area, primarily for retaining the control over the territory, it is said to be identified with colonialism.

Whatever may be the distinction between the two, both imperialism and colonialism pertain to a relationship of domination and subordination of one area and its people by another area and its government. The most significant thing about colonialism and imperialism is not that they can be precisely defined or that they cannot always be distinguished from each other, but both express a kind of relationship and thus used interchangeably and the distinction is often not preserved.[4] In the modern times, colonialism acquired more or less the same connotation as imperialism with the rise of the British, French, Dutch, Portuguese and Spanish Empires.

Over the past 400 years or more, European nations had subjugated two-thirds of the non-European world. Spain and Portugal were the early colonizers but their supremacy was challenged since 1600 AD by Holland, England and France who joined the race for scramble for colonies. The peak of colonization was reached in 1775 when the entire American, Asian and African continents became subjugated to